Re: Question on the UH Optometry program from a Y13 student

From: Scarlett Adams ScarlettAdams833@outlook.com
To: Manveer Seyan m.s.seyan@herts.ac.uk
Date: Wed, Nov 6, 2024, 13:46

Hello

I hope you are well. I am Scarlett Adams, a current Year 13 student who is interested in Optometry as one of my options for the upcoming academic year. I will be sitting A Levels in next summer's exams. Currently, I take Biology, Chemistry and Further Maths A Level (predicted AAA*)

I hope to do Optometry as a career and am highly interested and excited for the prospect. Vision care has interested me from a very young age.

Having done research I am aware that you are the admissions tutor for the UH MOptom program. I have some questions on the MOptom program you offer at Hertfordshire and would be grateful if you could answer them as best as you can.

I am aware that the A Level requirements of AAB-AAA for the MOptom course meet the GOC standards.

My enquiry concerns how these requirements adequately reflect the nature of the course content, the level of academic depth and the difficulty of course exams. In that, how do you ensure that the students entering the MOptom course will be able to follow the course content?

I am aware that one of the ways in which this is done is by setting the entry requirements at a particular level, which is higher for some courses than others.

I am aware that among all degrees in the School of Life and Medical Sciences, the MOptom asks for the highest entry grades for admission. In the case of the Optometry Masters, this is AAB to AAA. May you elaborate on why, in addition to meeting GOC standards, this is the case?

I presume it is something to do with if you ask for, say, AAA at A Level for Course X, you will need to have the level of understanding of a Triple A grade a level Science student to follow Course X's content and perform well in their exams.

In addition to satisfying the GOC requirements, can you please provide an explanation of why else this is done?
And how the entry requirements of AAB satisfy and adequately, transparently reflect the course content itself?

How can this same rationale be applied to the other courses at the school of life and medical sciences? Entry requirements are considerably lower for other courses in the school of life and medical sciences. Why?

I ask as I am really looking to choose a particularly academically challenging course at university.

Thanks

Scarlett

Sent from Outlook for iOS

From: askoptometry, UH askoptometry@herts.ac.uk
To: Scarlett Adams ScarlettAdams833@outlook.com
Date: Wed, Nov 13, 2024, 13:03

Dear Scarlett,

Many thanks for getting in touch regarding the entry requirements for the Master of Optometry (MOptom) programme at the University of Hertfordshire.

For students applying to the MOptom programme, **we require grades AAB at A-level** with **at least two A-levels from science subjects** (i.e. Biology or Human Biology, Maths, Physics or Chemistry). **One of the science A-Levels must be from Biology or Maths**. Applicants must also **achieve a "pass"** in the **practical elements** of any science A-levels. For **applicants re-sitting their A-levels, we require grade A's in any subject being repeated.**

In addition to the above, we also require **at least 5 GCSEs at Grade 5/B or above (including 5/B in English Language, Maths and the Sciences).**

All qualifications considered as part of the application process must be within **five years** of the course commencement date.

https://www.herts.ac.uk/courses/undergraduate/moptom-master-of-optometry

You are correct that the requirements listed above meet the General Optical Council's (GOC) standards. It is a four-year master's degree and the requirements reflect the academic rigour and depth of the course. The GOC is the regulatory body for optometry in the UK and they also have a set of a learning outcomes that all optometry undergraduates must meet. When our MOptom programme was approved by the GOC, they were content with the course's structure hence the reason why we offer it to applicants.

The entry requirements to the MOptom programme are higher than those for other courses (within the School of Life and Medical Sciences) at the university. This, as you've alluded to, is due to the GOC's requirements and the academic depth of the course. Not every course offered by the university has its entry requirements set by a professional/regulatory body and so we cannot comment on how those respective programmes determine their admissions criteria.

It's great to hear that you're interested in optometry as career and we wish you all the best on your journey to becoming an optometrist.

Best wishes,
Optometry Admissions Team,
University of Hertfordshire

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2 Emails